PRAYAGH NUTRI PRODUCTS
TASTING SWEET SUCCESS

Founded in the year 2000 with one unit in the outskirts of Hyderabad manufacturing candies, the company has extended its domain expertise to Eclairs, Lollipops, Center Filled Candies, Milk based Lacto Bonbons, Chocolate Coated Wafers, Moulded Chocolates & Cakes to emerge as a leading brand in the country with exports to over 25 countries worldwide.



VINOD LALWANI, Executive Director, Prayagh Nutri Products

Prayagh Nutri Products is an enterprise that has thrived on the passions of a father son duo. The Managing Director, Preetam Lalwani used his versatile networking skills to build an enormous distribution network in a short span of time to craft the company's success. Vinod Lalwani, a post graduate in Food Technology from CFTRI Mysore, with his vast experience in production, quality and R&D operations in the field of sugar confectionery and chocolates brought in his passion and technical expertise. It is due to the combined efforts of these masterminds, and a team of equally passionate and dedicated employees that Prayagh Nutri Products has been able to emerge as the 5th Largest Player in the Confectionery category, 6th Largest in the Chocolate category & 5th Largest in the Cakes category in India in a short span of 20 years

Prayagh Nutri Products operates 3 Manufacturing plants and employs 1300+ people to cater to over 8 Lakh outlets across the country. The company is gearing up to achieve a challenging growth target of INR 1500 crores by FY 25-26, which will place Prayagh Nutri Products among t the top 3 players in each of the categories it operates.

Vinod Lalwani was kind enough to answer our questions and share a few insights into the organization's success and future plans.

1. WERE YOU A LEGACY ENTREPRENEUR? HOW DID YOU DECIDE THAT YOUR CALLING WAS IN THE FMCG PACKAGED FOOD CATEGORY?

ANS: My father was traditionally in the textile business. Very early on, I realised I was not interested in this line of business. After my graduation, I joined a company which was into manufacturing cough lozenges. Attracted to the industrial process involved, I found my calling in confectionaries. I pursued and completed my postgraduation in food technology and started Prayagh Nutri Products Pvt Ltd in Hyderabad at the turn of the millennium.

In the short stint that I had after my graduation, the challenges thrown at me stimulated my mind to seek solutions and sharpened my problem solving skills. I discovered that I had a natural talent to discern and appreciate tastes. These two abilities, one acquired and one natural, gave me a strong conviction to start my own confectionery and chocolate business.

2. WHAT WAS THE MOTIVATION TO CREATE OTHER PRODUCTS AND CREATE YOUR OWN BRANDS?

ANS: I wanted to utilize my potential to deliver great tasting products in the most efficient way possible. It was my desire to satisfy the consumers with outstanding quality and great value, not just in the domestic markets but also across the globe. This strong desire and ambition of mine led to the creation of innovative products, enabling our brand to consolidate its position in the market. This ambition continues to be strong across all these years. I still yearn to enhance our standards further and reach out to more consumers, transforming our organization into a true global entity with its roots firmly set in India

3. WHAT IS YOUR MANAGEMENT OR LEADERSHIP PHILOSOPHY?

ANS: It takes a great team to build great brands. It's very important to keep your entire team motivated - from the doorman to the CEO by inspiring and enriching them, so that they respect you as a true leader. Great motivation, efficient planning & timely execution are the three mantras I have taught each and every single member of our team. A word of advice that I always give is to never bring your ego into your work. It is good to have strong opinions while making decisions, but never fail to take advice from others.

4. WOULD YOU LIKE TO SHARE ANY ANECDOTES THAT HAVE HAD A DRAMATIC IMPACT ON YOU?

ANS: In 2009, we started unit 2 with a huge investment of INR 30 Crores. While it did feel like a big challenge. I was very confident about the growing consumption story of India and that it will take Prayagh from INR 150 Crores to INR 500 Crores per annum. It was a big risk and it has definitely paid off. So, don't be afraid of taking risks and be assured"....no risk... no gain".

With such clarity of thoughts and a wonderful spirit of teamwork, it is not surprising to smell the waft of success emanating from here.